



Grade 11 Geography

6. 🌍 Impacts of Development on the Environment

Learning Guide



1. What is Development Aid?

- **Development aid** is also called:
 - **International aid**
 - **Foreign aid**
- It refers to assistance given by **foreign countries or organisations**, known as **donors**, to help LEDCs improve:
 - Economic development
 - Social development
 - Environmental development
 - Standard of living

Important Principle

Development aid should be:

- **Appropriate** to the needs of the receiving country.
- Designed to **empower people and communities**.
- Used in a way that does **not undermine development** in LEDCs.

★ **Key idea:** Development aid should help countries become stronger and improve living conditions rather than weaken their ability to develop independently.



2. Donor and Recipient Countries

Donor

- A country or organisation that **provides aid**.

Recipient

- The country that **receives the aid**.

Aid may therefore flow:

Donor → Aid → Recipient country

The nature of the aid depends on who provides it, how it is distributed, and what it is intended to achieve.



3. Official Aid

- **Official aid** is authorised assistance given:
 - From one country to another.
 - Or from an international organisation to a country.

Official aid therefore involves recognised governments or international organisations.

★ **Key idea:** Official aid is formally authorised assistance.

ZA → 🌍 4. Bilateral Aid

- **Bilateral aid** is aid given **directly from one country to another**.
- There is a direct relationship between:
 - The donor country.
 - The recipient country.

Simple Flow

Country A → Country B

★ **Memory tip:** Bi = two → two countries are directly involved.



5. Multilateral Aid

- **Multilateral aid** is aid given by a donor to an **international organisation**.
- The organisation then distributes the aid among LEDCs.

Examples of Organisations

- **International Monetary Fund (IMF)**
- **World Bank**

Simple Flow

Donor → International organisation → LEDCs



Key difference:

Bilateral = country directly to country

Multilateral = aid passes through an international organisation



6. Voluntary / Charity Aid

- **Voluntary aid**, also called **charity aid**, is collected by aid agencies.
- It is given voluntarily by:
 - Individuals.
 - Corporations.

Voluntary aid may be **short-term** or **long-term**.

A. Short-Term Voluntary Aid

- Usually provided during **emergencies**.
- Organisations examples include:
 - **Oxfam**
 - **Red Cross**

Examples

After an earthquake or volcanic eruption, aid may include:

- Medicine.
- Food parcels.
- Emergency assistance.



Key idea: Short-term aid deals with immediate needs during a crisis.

B. Long-Term Voluntary Aid

- Usually provided by **NGOs** to support development over a longer period.

Examples

- Building schools.
- Building orphanages.
- Other development projects.



Key idea: Long-term aid tries to create lasting improvements rather than only responding to emergencies.



7. Technical Aid

- **Technical aid** is assistance in the form of:
 - Skilled technological advice.
 - Professional expertise.
 - Practical assistance.

Who Provides It?

- Often provided by **skilled engineers**.
- Funding may come from the **World Bank**.

What Can Be Built?

Technical aid may assist with infrastructure such as:

- Roads.
- Bridges.
- Power stations.
- Dams.

Example

- **Lesotho Highlands Water Scheme**

✚ **Key idea:** Technical aid provides skills and expertise, not simply money or goods.

🔗 8. Conditional Aid

- **Conditional aid** is aid given **subject to a specific condition**.
- It usually involves an agreement between:
 - The donor country.
 - The recipient country.
- It therefore has certain **“strings attached.”**

Example include

- A donor organisation may agree to build a road.
- In return, the recipient country may be required to trade raw materials with the donor.

Examples of Raw Materials

- Rubber.
- Oil.
- Cotton.

Simple Relationship

Donor gives aid → Recipient must meet a condition

✚ **Key idea:** Conditional aid is not given freely; the recipient must agree to certain requirements.

🚚 9. Humanitarian Aid

- **Humanitarian aid** provides support to people in order to improve their **living conditions**.

It may include:

Skills and Social Support

- Skills training.
- Money to reduce debt.
- Medical assistance.
- Care for HIV/AIDS orphans.

Disaster Assistance

Humanitarian aid may also be provided after disasters such as:

- Floods.
- Droughts.

Emergency Supplies

Recipient countries may receive:

- Food.
- Water.
- Emergency supplies.
- Other forms of help.

Recovery and Rebuilding

- Donor countries may also help LEDCs **recover and rebuild after disasters**.

✚ **Key idea:** Humanitarian aid focuses directly on helping people, especially during hardship and disasters.

📋 10. Main Types of Development Aid – Comparison

Type of Aid	Meaning
Official aid	Formally authorised aid from governments or international organisations
Bilateral aid	Directly from one country to another
Multilateral aid	Given through an international organisation such as the IMF or World Bank
Voluntary aid	Donations collected by aid agencies from individuals and corporations
Technical aid	Skilled advice and assistance, especially for infrastructure
Conditional aid	Aid given with specific conditions attached
Humanitarian aid	Assistance aimed at improving living conditions or helping during disasters

✓ 11. Advantages of Development Aid

1. Poverty Reduction

- Aid provides essential resources and services.
- This can help reduce poverty.

2. Infrastructure Development

- Aid can finance:
 - Roads.
 - Schools.
 - Hospitals.
 - Other infrastructure.

3. Health Improvements

- Supports health programmes.
- Can reduce disease.
- Improves health outcomes.

4. Education Access

- Improves access to education.
- May increase literacy levels.

5. Humanitarian Relief

- Provides immediate assistance during:
 - Natural disasters.
 - Conflicts.

6. Capacity Building

- Training and knowledge transfer can develop **local skills and abilities**.

7. Economic Growth

- Development projects may:
 - Create jobs.
 - Stimulate economic activity.

8. Social Development

- Aid may support:
 - Gender equality.
 - Human rights.

9. Political Stability

- Aid may help address some causes of conflict and contribute to stability.

10. International Relations

- Aid can strengthen relationships between:
 - Donor countries.
 - Recipient countries.

✦ **Key idea:** Effective aid can improve infrastructure, skills, health, education and economic opportunities.

✗ 12. Disadvantages of Development Aid

1. Dependency

- Countries may become too dependent on aid.
- This can reduce **self-sufficiency**.

2. Mismanagement

- Aid may be:
 - Misused.
 - Misallocated.
- Corrupt officials may prevent aid from reaching the people who need it.

3. Undermining Local Economies

- Free imported goods may compete with local businesses.
- Local producers may struggle to sell their products.

4. Donor Influence

- Donor countries may impose their own:

- Policies.
- Priorities.
- This may influence decisions in recipient countries.

5. Short-Term Focus

- Aid may concentrate on immediate relief rather than **long-term sustainable development**.

6. Inefficiency

- Bureaucratic processes may slow down:
 - Delivery.
 - Effectiveness of aid.

7. Debt Burden

- Aid given as **loans** may increase the recipient country's debt.

8. Aid Fatigue

- Donors may become less willing to continue giving aid over time.
- Contributions may decrease.

9. Inequitable Distribution

- Aid may not reach the people who need it most.

10. Distorted Priorities

- Recipient countries may focus on **donor-funded projects** instead of their own development priorities.



Key idea:

Aid can become harmful when it creates dependency, increases debt, supports donor priorities or fails to reach the intended people.



13. Advantages vs Disadvantages

Advantages	Disadvantages
Reduces poverty	May create dependency
Builds infrastructure	Can be mismanaged
Improves healthcare	May harm local businesses
Expands education	Donors may influence policies
Provides disaster relief	May focus only on short-term problems
Builds local skills	Bureaucracy may delay aid
Creates jobs and growth	Loans can create debt
Supports social development	Donor fatigue may develop
Can improve stability	Aid may be distributed unfairly
Strengthens international relations	Local priorities may be distorted



14. Final Exam Summary

- **Development aid** is assistance provided by foreign countries or organisations to support development and improve living standards in LEDCs.
- Aid should be:
 - Appropriate.
 - Empowering.
 - Supportive of development.
- **Bilateral aid** → directly from one country to another.
- **Multilateral aid** → distributed through organisations such as the IMF or World Bank.
- **Official aid** → formally authorised aid.
- **Voluntary aid** → donated by individuals and corporations through aid organisations.
- Voluntary aid may be:
 - Short-term emergency aid.
 - Long-term development aid.
- **Technical aid** → skills and specialist assistance.
- Example: **Lesotho Highlands Water Scheme**.

- **Conditional aid** → has conditions or “strings attached”.
- **Humanitarian aid** → directly supports people and disaster recovery.
- Development aid may:
 - Reduce poverty.
 - Build infrastructure.
 - Improve education and health.
 - Create jobs.
 - Provide emergency assistance.
- However, it may also:
 - Create dependency.
 - Increase debt.
 - Be mismanaged.
 - Damage local economies.
 - Give donor countries too much influence.

★ **Core idea:** Development aid is most effective when it meets local needs, develops local capacity, and helps recipient countries achieve sustainable development rather than long-term dependence

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